“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 10

The Trunk and Branches of Śrī Caitanya’s Tree

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Again and again I bow to the bees who drink the honey of Śrī Caitanya’s lotus feet. By somehow taking shelter of them, even a dog may come to share in that fragrance.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 This gardener and this tree are beyond description. Now hear the names of the main branches.

4 Among the many associates of Caitanya Gosāñi, no one can determine who is lesser and who is greater.

5 Many great souls have counted them all, yet none could arrange them in order of senior and junior.

6 Therefore, bowing to them all, I simply give their names. Please do not hold this against me.

7 “I worship the dear devotees of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who are the branches of His immortal tree of love and who give the fruit of love for Kṛṣṇa.”

8 Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita and Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita: these two brothers are two branches renowned throughout the world.

9 Śrīpati and Śrīnidhi are their two brothers. The servants and maidservants of the four brothers and their whole household

10 are all counted among the sub-branches of these two branches. In their house Mahāprabhu always held saṅkīrtana.

11 With their whole family they serve Śrī Caitanya; they know no god or goddess other than Gauracandra.

12 One great branch bears the name Ācāryaratna; his associates are his branches and sub-branches.

13 Ācāryaratna's name is Śrī Candraśekhara. In his house the Lord danced in the mood of the Goddess.

14 I know Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi to be a great branch. The Lord Himself wept as He spoke his name.

15 A great branch is Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosāñi. He is Lakṣmī in person, and no one is his equal.

16 His disciples and their disciples are his sub-branches. In this way I record all the branches and sub-branches.

17 Vakreśvara Paṇḍita is the Lord's very dear servant. Absorbed in a single mood, he would dance for twenty-four *praharas* — three days and nights.

18 While he danced, Mahāprabhu Himself would sing. Clasping the Lord's feet, Vakreśvara said:

19 “O moon-faced One, give me ten thousand Gandharvas! Let them sing while I dance — then I shall be happy.”

20 The Lord said, “You are a branch — one of My wings. If I had another wing, I would fly up into the sky.”

21 Paṇḍita Jagadānanda is the Lord’s very life. People know him as Satyabhāmā herself.

22 Out of love he wanted to care for the Lord and look after His comfort, but the Lord, mindful of His renunciation and of what people would say, never accepted it.

23 So the two of them would bicker and quarrel. I shall tell the whole story of his love later.

24 Rāghava Paṇḍita is the Lord’s first follower. One principal branch from him is Makaradhvaja Kara.

25 His sister Damayantī is the Lord’s dear maidservant. All year round she prepares foodstuffs for the Lord.

26 Rāghava fills bags with all those preparations and carries them to the Lord, keeping them hidden.

27 The Lord accepts them all year long, and they became famous as “Rāghava’s bags.”

28 I shall describe all those preparations in detail later. Hearing of them, devotees shed streams of tears.

29 Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa is extremely dear to the Lord; by remembering him, one is freed from all bondage.

30 Śrī Purandara Ācārya is Śrī Caitanya's associate. Gaurāṅga-sundara called him father.

31 Dāmodara Paṇḍita is a branch fierce in love. He even rebuked the Lord with words.

32 I shall tell the story of that rebuke in detail later. Pleased by it, the Lord sent him to Nadīyā.

33 His younger brother, Śaṅkara Paṇḍita, is a branch. He is known as "the Lord's foot-pillow."

34 Sadāśiva Paṇḍita's one hope is the Lord's feet. When Nityānanda first came, He stayed in his house.

35 Pradyumna Brahmacārī worshiped Śrī Nṛsiṁha. The Lord gave him the name Nṛsiṁhānanda.

36 Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita is another, most generous. He knows nothing but Śrī Caitanya's feet.

37 The branch Śrīmān Paṇḍita is the Lord's personal servant. He holds the torch when the Lord dances.

38 Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī is most fortunate: the Lord begged for his food, snatched it and ate it.

39 The branch Nandana Ācārya is renowned throughout the world. In his house the two Lords stayed in hiding.

40 The branch Śrī Mukunda Datta was the Lord's classmate. Caitanya Gosāñi dances to his kīrtana.

41 Vāsudeva Datta is the Lord's servant, a great soul. Even with a thousand mouths one could not describe his qualities.

42 He wanted to take on himself the sins of every living being in the world and suffer in hell, to set them free.

43 The life of the branch Haridāsa Ṭhākura is wonderful. Without fail he chanted three hundred thousand names.

44 His qualities are endless; I give only a hint of them. Ācārya Gosāñi fed him the plate of the *śrāddha* ceremony.

45 The waves of his qualities are like Prahlāda's: even when the Muslims beat him, he did not so much as frown.

46 When he attained perfection, Caitanya Prabhu took his body in His arms and danced in great joy.

47 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described his pastimes; whatever remains I shall bring to light later.

48 His sub-branches are all the people of Kulīna-grāma, headed by Satyarāja, who received his mercy.

49 The branch Śrī Murāri Gupta is a storehouse of love. Hearing of his humility, the Lord's heart melts.

50 He accepts no gifts and takes no one's wealth; he supports his family by his own profession.

51 Whoever he kindly treats is cured of both diseases — the disease of the body and the disease of worldly existence (*bhava-roga*).

52 Śrīmān Sena is the Lord's chief servant. He knows nothing but Śrī Caitanya's feet.

53 The branch Śrī Gadādhara dāsa is above all, for he made the Kazis say "Hari."

54 Śivānanda Sena is an intimate servant of the Lord. Everyone going to the Lord travels in his company.

55 Every year he takes the Lord's devotees with him to Nīlācala, looking after them on the way.

56 The Lord shows mercy to His devotees in three ways: in person (*sākṣāt*), by entering someone (*āveśa*), and by appearing (*āvirbhāva*).

57 In person, all the devotees saw Him alike. In the body of Nakula Brahmacārī the Lord was present by *āveśa*.

58 His earlier name was Pradyumna Brahmacārī; later the Lord named him Nṛsiṁhānanda.

59 In him Śrī Caitanya was present by *āvirbhāva*. The Lord has many such extraordinary ways.

60 Śivānanda Sena tasted all these mercies. I shall describe all this bliss in detail later.

61 Śivānanda's sub-branches are his associates — his sons, servants and others, all servants of Śrī Caitanya.

62 Caitanya dāsa, Rāmadāsa and Karṇapūra, the three sons of Śivānanda, are heroic devotees of the Lord.

63 Śrīvallabha Sena and Śrīkānta Sena, Śivānanda's relatives, are wholeheartedly devoted to the Lord.

64 Govindānanda, dear to the Lord, is a great devotee (*mahā-bhāgavata*). Śrī Govinda Datta is the Lord's chief kīrtana singer.

65 Śrī Vijaya dāsa is the Lord's scribe; he copied many books and gave them to the Lord.

66 The Lord gave him the name Ratnabāhu, "Jewel-armed." Dear to the Lord also is the penniless Kṛṣṇadāsa.

67 Śrīdhara, the seller of banana bark, is the Lord's dear servant, with whom the Lord always joked.

68 Every day the Lord took his banana pith, banana flowers and fruits, and the Lord drank water from his broken iron pot.

69 Bhagavān Paṇḍita is the Lord's very dear servant. Kṛṣṇa formerly dwelt in his body.

70 Jagadīśa Paṇḍita and Hiraṇya Mahāśaya received the merciful Lord's mercy in His childhood:

71 in these two houses, on the day of Ekādaśī, the Lord begged for the food offered to Viṣṇu and ate it Himself.

72 Two of the Lord's students, Puruṣottama and Sañjaya, were His disciples in grammar — two great souls.

73 The branch Vanamālī Paṇḍita is famous in the world. He saw a golden club and plow in the Lord's hands.

74 Buddhimanta Khān is very dear to Śrī Caitanya. From birth he carried out the Lord's orders; he is one of His chief servants.

75 Garuḍa Paṇḍita chants the auspicious holy name; by the strength of the name, poison had no power over him.

76 Gopīnātha Siṁha is a servant of Śrī Caitanya; the Lord jokingly called him Akrūra.

77 By Vakreśvara's mercy, Devānanda, the reciter of the *Bhāgavata*, received from the Lord the meaning of the *Bhāgavata* as devotion.

78–79 From Khaṇḍa: Mukunda dāsa, Śrī Raghunandana, Narahari dāsa, Cirañjīva and Sulocana. All these are great branches, abodes of Śrī Caitanya's mercy; they give away the fruits and flowers of love everywhere.

80 The residents of Kulīna-grāma — Satyarāja, Rāmānanda, Yadunātha, Puruṣottama, Śaṅkara, Vidyānanda,

81 Vāṇīnātha Vasu and all the other villagers — all are servants of Śrī Caitanya, and Śrī Caitanya is the treasure of their life.

82 The Lord said, "Even a dog of Kulīna-grāma is dear to Me, what to speak of its people!

83 The fortune of the people of Kulīna-grāma cannot be described: even the Ḍom who herds pigs there sings of Kṛṣṇa."

84 Anupama (Vallabha), Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana are counted as three branches on the western side of the tree.

85 Among them Rūpa and Sanātana are the great branches; Anupama, Jīva, Rājendra and others are sub-branches.

86 By the gardener's will the branches grew greatly and spread over all the western lands,

87 as far as the banks of the Sindhu and the Himālayas, with Vṛndāvana, Mathurā and all the holy places.

88 The fruit of love from these two branches flooded everything, and the people who tasted it went mad with love.

89 The people of the west were all foolish and without proper conduct; there the two brothers preached devotion and right conduct.

90 Guided by scripture, they recovered the lost holy places, and in Vṛndāvana they spread the worship of the Deity.

91 Raghunātha dāsa is Mahāprabhu's dear servant. Giving up everything, he came to live at the Lord's feet.

92 The Lord entrusted him to Svarūpa, and together with Svarūpa he rendered confidential service to the Lord.

93 For sixteen years he served the Lord intimately. When Svarūpa disappeared from this world, he came to Vṛndāvana.

94 He thought, "In Vṛndāvana I shall see the feet of the two brothers, and then I shall give up my body by leaping from Govardhana."

95 With this resolve he came to Vṛndāvana and bowed at the feet of Rūpa and Sanātana.

96 But the two brothers did not let him die. They made him their third brother and kept him by their side.

97 From his lips the two brothers constantly heard all of Mahāprabhu's pastimes, both outward and inward.

98 He gave up food and water, to say nothing of other things; he took only two or three *palas* of buttermilk.

99 Every day he offered a thousand prostrations, chanted a hundred thousand names and bowed to two thousand Vaiṣṇavas.

100 Day and night he served Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa within his mind, and for one *prahara* he spoke of Mahāprabhu's life.

101 Three times a day, without fail, he bathed in Rādhā-kuṇḍa, and he embraced and honored the Vaiṣṇavas of Vraja.

102 He spent seven and a half *praharas* in the practice of devotion and slept four *daṇḍas* — and on some days not even that.

103 His way of practice is amazing to hear. Those very Rūpa and Raghunātha are my masters.

104 How all of them met the Lord I shall describe in detail later.

105 Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa is one of the very best branches; he speaks of divine love with Rūpa and Sanātana.

106 Śaṅkarāraṇya is a branch of the *ācārya* tree; Mukunda, Kāśīnātha and Rudra are recorded as its sub-branches.

107 Śrīnātha Paṇḍita received the Lord's mercy; his service to Kṛṣṇa captivates the three worlds.

108 Jagannātha Ācārya is the Lord's dear servant; by the Lord's order he lived on the bank of the Gaṅgā.

109 Kṛṣṇadāsa Vaidya, Paṇḍita Śekhara, Kavicandra, the kīrtana singer Ṣaṣṭhīvara,

110 Śrīnātha Miśra, Śubhānanda, Śrīrāma, Īśāna, Śrīnidhi, Śrī Gopīkānta, Miśra Bhagavān,

111 Subuddhi Miśra, Hṛdayānanda, Kamala-nayana, Maheśa Paṇḍita, Śrīkara, Śrī Madhusūdana,

112 Puruṣottama, Śrī Gālīma, Jagannātha dāsa, Śrī Candraśekhara Vaidya, the brāhmaṇa Haridāsa,

113 Rāmadāsa, Kavidatta, Śrī Gopāla dāsa, Bhāgavatācārya, Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa,

114 Jagannātha Tīrtha, the brāhmaṇa Śrī Jānakīnātha, Gopāla Ācārya and the brāhmaṇa Vāṇīnātha.

115 Govinda, Mādhava and Vāsudeva are three brothers; Caitanya and Nitāi dance to their kīrtana.

116 Rāmadāsa Abhirāma is a treasury of love in friendship. He lifted a log that took sixteen men to carry and made it into a flute.

117 By the Lord's order Nityānanda went to Gauḍa, and by the Lord's order three devotees went with Him:

118 Śrī Rāmadāsa, Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa. Govinda stayed with the Lord, fully content.

119 Bhāgavatācārya, Cirañjīva, Śrī Raghunandana, Mādhavācārya, Kamalākānta, Śrī Yadunandana.

120 Jagāi and Mādhāi received the Lord's great mercy. These two brothers bear witness to His name "Savior of the Fallen."

121 Thus I have briefly told of the devotees of Gauḍa. Śrī Caitanya's devotees are endless; they cannot be counted.

122 All these devotees were also with the Lord in Nīlācala; in both places they served Him in many joyful ways.

123 Now I shall briefly tell of those devotees of the Lord who were in Nīlācala alone.

124–126 Of all the devotees with the Lord in Nīlācala, two were the chief, the Lord's very heart: Paramānanda Purī and Svarūpa Dāmodara. With them were Gadādhara, Jagadānanda, Śaṅkara, Vakreśvara, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Ṭhākura Haridāsa, Raghunātha Vaidya and Raghunātha dāsa.

127 These and other great devotees, His companions from earlier days, stayed in Nīlācala and served the Lord.

128 All the other devotees, who lived in Gauḍa, came to Nīlācala every year to see the Lord.

129 Now I shall list the devotees who first met the Lord in Nīlācala.

130 One great branch is Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, and another his sister's husband, Śrī Gopīnāthācārya.

131 Kāśī Miśra, Pradyumna Miśra and Rāya Bhavānanda — meeting them, the Lord felt great joy.

132 Embracing Bhavānanda, the Lord said, “You are Pāṇḍu, and the five Pāṇḍavas are your sons:

133 Rāmānanda Rāya, Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka, Kalānidhi, Sudhānidhi and Vāṇīnātha Nāyaka.

134 These five sons of yours are dear to Me. Between Rāmānanda and Me the only difference is the body.”

135–136 King Pratāparudra, the Oriya Kṛṣṇānanda, Paramānanda Mahāpātra, the Oriya Śivānanda, Bhagavān Ācārya, Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Śrī Śikhi Māhiti and Murāri Māhiti.

137 Mādhavī-devī, Śikhi Māhiti’s sister, is counted among the maidservants of Śrī Rādhā.

138 Kāśīśvara Brahmacārī was a disciple of Īśvara Purī, and Śrī Govinda was his dear attendant.

139 When Īśvara Purī passed away, the two of them, following his order, came to the Lord in Nīlācala.

140 Because of their relation to His guru, the Lord honored them both, and in obedience to His guru’s order He gave them both service.

141 The Lord gave Govinda the service of His body, and when He went to see Jagannātha, Kāśīśvara walked ahead of Him.

142 So that Gosāñi could pass untouched through the thick crowd, the strong Kāśīśvara pushed the people aside and cleared the way.

143 Rāmāi and Nandāi are both servants of the Lord; they serve constantly with Govinda.

144 Rāmāi fills twenty-two pots of water every day, and Nandāi serves as Govinda directs.

145 Kṛṣṇadāsa, a pure *kulīna* brāhmaṇa, is the one the Lord took with Him on His journey to the south.

146 Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya, qualified in devotion, was the Lord's *brahmacārī* on His journey to Mathurā.

147 The elder Haridāsa and the younger Haridāsa, two kīrtana singers, stayed by Mahāprabhu's side.

148 Rāmabhadrācārya, the Oriya Siṁheśvara, Tapana Ācārya, Raghu, Nīlāmbara,

149 Siṅgābhaṭṭa, Kāmābhaṭṭa, Dantura Śivānanda, and Kamalānanda, the Lord's dear servant from earlier days in Gauḍa,

150 and Acyutānanda, the son of Advaita Ācārya, who stayed in Nīlācala, taking shelter at the Lord's feet;

151 Nirloma Gaṅgādāsa and Viṣṇudāsa — all these lived with the Lord in Nīlācala.

152–153 In Vārāṇasī the Lord had three devotees: Candraśekhara the physician, Tapana Miśra, and Miśra's son Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya. When the Lord came to Kāśī after seeing Vṛndāvana,

154 He stayed for two months in Candraśekhara's house and for two months took His meals in the house of Tapana Miśra.

155 As a boy, Raghunātha served the Lord, cleaning up after His meals and massaging His feet.

156 When he had grown up, he went to the Lord in Nīlācala and stayed for eight months; on some days he cooked the Lord's meal and offered it to Him.

157 Receiving the Lord's order, he came to Vṛndāvana and stayed with Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi.

158 Rūpa Gosāñi would hear the *Bhāgavata* from him. By the Lord's mercy he was intoxicated with love for Kṛṣṇa.

159 Thus Śrī Caitanya's devotees are countless. I write only a hint; they cannot be fully described.

160 On each branch grow millions upon millions of twigs: its disciples and their disciples are its offshoots.

161 All are laden with the flowers and fruits of love; they have flooded the three worlds with the waters of love for Kṛṣṇa.

162 Each single branch has infinite power and glory; even the thousand-mouthed Ananta cannot find their limit.

163 I have spoken of Mahāprabhu's devotees only in brief; even the thousand-mouthed Ananta cannot tell of them all.

164 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.